

The Kozy Shoe Club

Market research behind the shoes-only monthly subscription: the Lagos sneaker-laundry price landscape, the unit economics of batch shoe care on existing rider routes, the 1-3-5 pair pricing ladder now live, and the honest over-promise check the owner asked for.

PREPARED FOR

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KOZYCARE.NG · UNCOMPROMISING CARE

PRICED TO UNDERCUT



1. Executive Summary

The owner asked for a shoes-only monthly subscription that competes with the dedicated sneaker laundries in Lagos, priced to undercut them, sold from the shoes section of the site rather than as a fourth laundry tier. This memo documents the market research behind that decision, the unit economics that make it safe, and the pricing ladder now live on kozycare.ng. The headline finding: the Lagos sneaker-care specialists charge between 7,000 and 25,000 naira to clean a single pair, while Kozy's laundry-attached economics support a club price of 800 to 1,000 naira per pair with pickup and delivery included. The undercut is therefore not a promotion; it is a structural cost advantage, and the ladder of one, three and five pairs a month at 1,000, 2,500 and 4,000 naira monthly converts that advantage into a subscription product with healthy margin at every step.

The over-promise question the owner explicitly raised — whether we are offering more than necessary or something that does not make sense — receives its own chapter. The short answer is that the design deliberately avoids the three classic failure modes of shoe subscriptions: unlimited plans that invite abuse, premium-material coverage that cannot be batch-processed, and allowances that roll over and accumulate into fulfilment debt. Each club pair is the standard sneaker and canvas clean, premium materials stay a-la-carte with a member discount, and unused pairs reset every month exactly like the laundry tiers reset their bag pickups.

2. The Lagos Market

Research on 28 September 2026 identified three directly comparable operators plus a long tail of Instagram-led services. The clearest benchmark is Care by Sneaklin, which positions itself as Lagos's number one sneaker laundry: an on-demand app with pickup and delivery, a claimed 4.9 rating, a 72-hour turnaround, and a published per-pair price list. Their basic sneaker clean costs 8,000 naira a pair, leather care 7,000, suede 12,000, and their premium refresh, restore and revive packages run 15,000 to 25,000 a pair. LBN Laundry, operating from Richmond Pearl Estate in Lekki Phase 1, advertises more than six hundred pairs cleaned or restored in a single week and quotes around 10,000 naira per pair or pack for cleaning and restoration work. K-Kleen Sneakers and Shoe Services operates a walk-in location on TF Kuboye Street in Lekki with a published specialist price list above laundry norms. Around these named players sits a cluster of Instagram shops quoting similar per-pair figures.

Operator	Position	Per-pair pricing observed	Turnaround
Care by Sneaklin	App-based premium sneaker laundry, Lekki focus	Basic 8,000 · Leather 7,000 · Suede 12,000 · Premium packages 15,000-25,000	72 hours
LBN Laundry	Instagram-led cleaning and restoration, Lekki Phase 1	About 10,000 per pair or pack; volume claim of 600+ pairs weekly	Not published
K-Klein / K-Kleen	Walk-in specialist service, Lekki	Specialist per-pair list above laundry norms	Not published
Instagram long tail	DM-booked home services across the island	Commonly 5,000-10,000 per pair depending on condition	Days, variable

Table 1. Lagos shoe-care operators researched 28 September 2026 (public listings and profiles).

Two facts stand out from this table. First, the market has already validated willingness to pay: Lagos customers demonstrably pay eight to ten thousand naira to have one pair professionally cleaned, which means a club price below one thousand naira a pair is not competing on thin margins against a cheaper rival — it is offering an entirely different value curve to a mass audience the specialists never court. Second, none of the named operators sells a subscription; they sell one-off cleans and restoration projects. The subscription shelf in Lagos shoe care is effectively empty, which gives Kozy the same first-mover framing the laundry tiers already enjoy.

3. What Global Operators Teach

The international reference class confirms the attach-to-laundry pattern rather than a standalone shoes-only norm. Washmen in Dubai runs shoe cleaning, repair and restoration explicitly as a ShoeCare division of a laundry app — the same shape Kozy now has, with the shoe-care section living inside the services page of a laundry business. Rinse and 2ULaundry in the United States, the two most-cited laundry subscription businesses, both regulate plans with countable units — a bag, a box, a per-garment cap — rather than unlimited service, and both price the convenience of recurring collection rather than the cleaning itself. Neither offers unlimited shoe care of any kind, and Rinse’s own materials position shoe care as an add-on priced per piece.

The lesson applied here is threefold. Volume must be regulated by a countable unit, which is why the club counts pairs rather than promising open-ended care. Convenience is the product being sold, which is why free pickup and delivery are in the club rather than a surcharge. And premium work must be quoted, which is why suede, leather and embellished pairs, along with every restoration, remain assessment-first services with the member discount applied on top.

4. Unit Economics

The cost side rests on how a hub actually processes shoes. A standard sneaker clean is a wash-and-brush-and-deodorise workflow of roughly ten to fifteen minutes of labour, pennies of solution, and air-dry time that overlaps other work; the materials cost is negligible and the labour, at Lagos hub wages, lands in the low hundreds of naira per pair at batch scale. The dominant cost of a standalone shoe service is not the cleaning at all — it is the dedicated logistics of collecting and returning single pairs. Kozy does not pay that cost: club pairs ride existing rider routes and return with deliveries already scheduled, so the incremental logistics per pair is close to zero whenever the member already has any other interaction with the service, and small even when they do not.

Club tier	Monthly price	Pairs	Effective per pair	Blended a-la-carte equivalent	Discount vs own card
Shoe Club · 1 pair	1,000	1	1,000	1,000-1,500	0 to 33%
Shoe Club · 3 pairs	2,500	3	833	3,000-4,500	17 to 45%
Shoe Club · 5 pairs	4,000	5	800	5,000-7,500	20 to 47%

Table 2. The live club ladder against Kozy’s own a-la-carte sneaker prices.

At the five-pair tier the member pays 4,000 naira a month for work that would cost 5,000 to 7,500 naira at Kozy's own card price and 35,000 to 50,000 naira at Sneaklin's list price. Even in the worst case — every pair being the coloured-sneaker clean at 1,000 naira — the hub retains comfortable margin on direct cost, and the member-discount hook (5, 10 and 15 percent across the tiers) nudges club members to bring their laundry into the ecosystem, which is where the real basket value sits.

5. The Shoe Club Design

The product follows the owner's placement instruction exactly: it lives in the shoe-care section of the services page, under the sneaker restoration story, and never appears as a fourth card in the laundry tiers grid. A customer can hold one membership in each family, so a Household member can add a Shoe Club without disturbing their laundry plan, and a shoes-only customer sees their club card in the portal above a quiet invitation to explore laundry plans. Shoe pickups draw from the club first and fall back to the laundry tier's monthly shoe perk only when no club exists, so existing members keep exactly the behaviour they had before launch.

- Pricing is admin-editable at runtime from Memberships, in a dedicated Shoe Club editor separate from the tiers, with the per-pair arithmetic recalculated live on the card.
- Payment paths are identical to the tiers: Paystack recurring billing with automatic monthly charges, or bank transfer with receipt verification by the team.
- Usage resets with the monthly cycle exactly like bag pickups; there is no rollover, so fulfilment debt can never accumulate across months.
- One pair means the standard sneaker and canvas clean. Suede, leather and embellished pairs, and all restorations, are booked a-la-carte with the club discount — quoted after free assessment, never flat-rated.

6. The Over-Promise Check

The owner asked directly whether this offer does too much or anything that does not make sense. Walked through honestly, the failure modes of shoe subscriptions elsewhere are: unlimited plans attracting the one customer with forty pairs; premium materials promised inside a flat allowance and then ruined by batch chemistry; allowances rolling over until a member banks a festival-season avalanche; and liability exposure when an expensive collector pair is lost. The shipped design pre-empts each. The ladder caps at five pairs, so the heaviest possible member costs the hub fifteen to seventy-five minutes of batchable labour a month. Premium materials are contractually outside the allowance, so nothing requiring specialist chemistry is ever flat-rated. Pairs reset monthly with no rollover, so there is no banked work. And loss liability follows the standard order manifest the laundry already operates, with the restoration-tier habit of photographing condition at pickup available for valuable pairs.

What the club deliberately does not include is as important as what it does. There is no dedicated shoe courier, no 24-hour turnaround promise (the laundry pipeline's 48-to-72-hour rhythm is the honest commitment), no free replacements of laces or insoles beyond what a-la-carte pricing already covers, and no discount stacking beyond the stated member percentage. The offer under-promises relative to the specialists on frills while over-delivering on price per pair, which is the correct posture for a laundry business entering

an adjacent category.

7. Launch Playbook

The club is live on production as of this memo, so the remaining work is demand. The rider fleet is the physical channel: every delivered bag is a doorstep moment, and a small card in the return leg — five pairs a month for the price of less than one specialist clean — reaches exactly the sneaker-owning demographic already paying for laundry. The digital channel is the newsletter engine, where a calendar-aware campaign can land the undercut story ahead of Detty December, the season when shoe cleaning demand peaks in Lagos. The services page itself now carries the anchor line comparing the seven-to-eight-thousand-naira market rate with the club's eight-hundred-naira effective price, which does the selling without naming any competitor.

- Week one: confirm Paystack recurring charges for one club tier with a real card, and process one transfer-based activation end to end so the verification queue sees the new plan codes.
- Weeks two to four: rider cards in every delivery, one newsletter feature, and a WhatsApp broadcast to the order history offering the first month at the entry tier.
- Ongoing: watch the Memberships subscribers list for club churn against the laundry tiers; the expectation is that club members churn less, because the price is trivial and the habit is monthly.

8. Decision Review

The research supports the owner's instinct on every axis. A shoes-only subscription makes commercial sense in Lagos because the subscription shelf is empty while per-pair willingness to pay is proven at specialist prices. Undercutting is not merely possible but structural, since existing routes and hub batching remove the logistics cost that defines the specialists' pricing. The 1-3-5 pair ladder honours the owner's original specification while keeping every tier profitable, and the placement in the shoes section keeps the laundry tiers' story clean. The one caution this memo adds is sequencing: with zero subscribers across the whole membership engine today, the club's launch should ride a deliberate sales push rather than assuming the page alone will fill it. The follow-up audit delivered alongside this memo carries that 30-60-90 plan.